

Ἀστυδάμας ὁ Νεώτερος

Astydamas the Younger on Achilles and Thetis

eul_aid: fnw

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)
Dialect: *Δράμα Ἀττικόν* [Attic Drama](#)
Domain: *Δρᾶμα* [Drama](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Astydamas the Younger was an Athenian tragic poet of the 4th century BCE. He was the son of the tragedian Astydamas the Elder and the grandson of Philocles, a nephew of Aeschylus, placing him within a distinguished dramatic lineage. A contemporary of Demosthenes, he was noted for his exceptional pride; ancient sources record that he erected a statue of himself in the Theatre of Dionysus, an act met with public ridicule.

He was a prolific and successful playwright, credited with 240 tragedies and satyr plays, of which 15 won first prize. His surviving works exist only in fragments. Known titles include **Achilles**, **Athamas**, **Antigone**, **Hector**, and **Heracles**. He achieved a notable victory in 340 BCE for a production featuring **Achilles**, **Athamas**, and **Antigone**.

Astydamas represents the generation of tragedians following the 5th-century masters. His career demonstrates the continued vitality of Athenian tragic theatre in the Classical period beyond Sophocles and Euripides. The anecdote of his statue became a proverbial example of artistic vanity in antiquity.

Works (1)

- *Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀχιλλέως καὶ Θέτιδος* · [Fragments on Achilles and Thetis](#) · 35 passages